PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

HEAD START

4800 NE 74th Ave/ Portland, OR 97218

Telephone: (503) 916-5724

MEMO

Date: 02/27/2026

To: PPS School Board

From: Emily Glasgow, Senior Director of PK-5 Core Academics
Dana Stiles, Director of Early Learners (Head Start)

Subject: Head Start Action – Fiscal, Policy, and Procedure Approvals

---

BACKGROUND

A. Federal requirements call for the Governing Board of Head Starts to approve recommendations and reports for the program.
B. The Board of Directors for Portland Public Schools serves as the Governing Board for PPS Head Start.

1. PPS Head Start 2023 – 2025 OPK Amended Budget Workbook

As you know, our district currently faces rising costs and limited funding across our system. In order to balance the Early Learners Department budget while maintaining preschool access to the same number of children and families, PPS Head Start requests board approval of our Federal Head Start Change in Scope Application. The Executive Summary here.

The Change in Scope process – managed by the Office of Head Start – allows programs to adjust program funding without Congressional approval. It is a necessary step in PPS Head Start's budget balancing for SY26-27. The process allows us to request to serve fewer children while retaining the same federal funding to increase our per pupil funding rate. The justification for this need is higher staffing costs, changes in community need, and the flat funding through our federal Head Start grant. Reducing the number of Head Start seats will allow our program to better match funding with actual enrollment, operating costs, and personnel costs to ensure long-term program stability. Following the approval of the Change in Scope, our program will have the opportunity to increase preschool seats from other grantors in order to continue to serve the same number of students and families in our community. No currently enrolled children or families will be affected by this plan, and the change will take place for the 2026–27 school year. **The Parent Policy Council approved the Head Start Change in Scope as of February 2026.** Board approval is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

2. 2025 – 2026 PPS Head Start Program Self-Assessment Timeline

The annual Self-Assessment is a central tenet of continuous quality improvement for Head Start programs. The goal of the Self-Assessment is to meet Head Start Program Performance Standards and move toward program excellence in serving children and families. The process provides programs the means to regularly assess their own management systems and program operations in order to continually strengthen the program and the services and supports delivered to children and families. **The Parent Policy Council approved the Self-Assessment Timeline in December 2025**. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

3. Eligibility, Recruitment, Selection, Enrollment, and Attendance (ERSEA) Selection Criteria for SY26-27

PPS Early Learners enrolls students in Head Start according to Section 645 of the Head Start Act. Federal Poverty Guidelines are used to determine income eligibility for participation in Head Start programs. The poverty guidelines are adjusted for families of different sizes and may be used to determine financial eligibility for certain federal programs such as Head Start services. The guidelines are issued each year in the Federal Register, and as such, the program must provide an annual training to the Parent Policy Council and board on their ERSEA procedures and Enrollment Selection Criteria for the following school year. **The Parent Policy Council received training and approved the SY26-27 Enrollment Selection Criteria in February 2025.** Board approval is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

4. Updated PPS Head Start Policy & Procedures

1.A. Child Abuse & Neglect – PPS Head Start has revised Child Abuse & Neglect policy and procedures in accordance with the Head Start Program Performance Standard 45 CFR §1302.90(c) which mandates that staff protect children's safety and well-being. The procedure reflects Early Learner's current mandated reporter practices, partnership with ODHS, and staff expectations for need-to-know communication. **The Parent Policy Council approved these revised procedures in January 2026**. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.B. Transportation – PPS Head Start has revised the Transportation policy and procedures to align the Head Start Program Performance § 1303 Transportation. The revisions to this policy clarified the responsibilities of the PPS Early Learners Department and PPS Transportation Department, as well as procedures for McKinney-Vento transportation referrals. PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council approved these revised procedures on December 11, 2024. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

Items listed above are required to be reviewed, updated, and/or approved by the Parent Policy Council and Governing Board.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

All items listed above support the high quality, comprehensive wraparound services provided to the children and families attending PPS Head Start.

FISCAL IMPACT

The items included in this packet do not have any significant direct impacts on program or district funding. Some items are required as part of grant agreements (federal, state, and city) in order to maintain current funding. The Change in Scope will maintain fiscal sustainability of our Early Learners Preschool Program.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council provided input, reviewed, and approved these actions and items as noted above and as reflected in the attached meeting minutes.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

The timeline for implementation will be the 2025 – 2026 school year.

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

Board approval needed.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The goal of PPS Head Start is to prepare the city's diverse and resilient young children for successful transitions to kindergarten and beyond by leveraging each child's strengths, building their social competence, and developing school readiness skills.

In June 2022, the PPS School Board established a new set of goals. "It remains the core mission and responsibility of our school system to ensure that every student has opportunities to thrive and experience success. We are dedicated to the continuous improvements necessary to drive the system shifts that will better support our students, educators, and leaders and result in improved student performance." The Board adopted the following four priorities for the 2022-2027 time period to move the school district toward the above aspirations:

- Improve Third Grade Reading achievement
- Improve Fifth Grade Mathematics achievement
- Improve Eighth Grade Readiness
- Improve High School Graduation rates

The above items support the district's and School Board's vision and priorities.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Develop Board resolutions and obtain signatures of approval of the Board Chair of the attached documents.

As a member of the PPS Executive Leadership Team, I have reviewed this staff report.



__KJH__ (Initials)

ATTACHMENTS

A. 2025 Head Start Change in Scope Application
B. 2025 Change in Scope Board Approval Letter
C. 2025 Change in Scope Board Resolution
D. 2024-2025 Self-Assessment Timeline
E. 2024-2025 Self-Assessment Timeline Board Approval Letter
F. 2024-2025 Self-Assessment Timeline Board Resolution
G. 2025-26 ERSEA Training & Selection Criteria
H. 2025-26 ERSEA Training & Selection Criteria Board Approval Letter
I. 2025-26 ERSEA Training & Selection Criteria Board Resolution
J. Policy and Procedures
    a. Child Abuse & Neglect
    b. Transportation
K. Policy and Procedures Board Approval Letters
    a. Child Abuse & Neglect
    b. Transportation
L. Policy and Procedures Board Resolutions
    a. Child Abuse & Neglect
    b. Transportation